

Verenia (Oracle) CPQ JIRA project and workflow

Project name: Solutions Backlog

JIRA Backlog link: <https://verenia.atlassian.net/jira/software/c/projects/SB/boards/17/backlog?view=detail&issueLimit=100>

JIRA Sprint link: <https://verenia.atlassian.net/jira/software/c/projects/SB/boards/17>

Backlog is the place where all the new tasks are created and stored until they're in the Sprint, whereas Sprint is a 1-month pack of the tasks assigned to engineers and originally planned to be done in the known period of time.

Task example: <https://verenia.atlassian.net/browse/SB-3173>

The screenshot displays the Verenia JIRA interface for a task titled "Metal Sales - SB2 Refresh, Urgent Backup Needed". The interface is divided into several sections:

- Left Sidebar:** Contains navigation links for "Solutions Backlog" (highlighted with a red box), "Backlog", "Active sprints", "Reports", "Issues", "Components", "Releases", "Deployments", "On-call", "Project pages", "Add shortcut", and "Project settings".
- Header:** Shows the project name "SB-482: Metal Sales" and the task ID "SB-3173".
- Task Name:** "Metal Sales - SB2 Refresh, Urgent Backup Needed" (highlighted with a red box).
- Description:** "Urgent - Metal Sales will do a refresh of SB2 from prod, and there are some customizations in SB2 at risk which may need to be backed up within the next 3 hours (5PM CST)".
- Attachments:** Three attachments are listed: "Metal Sales (GS).zip", "Metal Sales (Config).zip", and "Custom Trim (Config).zip" (highlighted with a red box).
- Activity:** A section for task activity, showing a comment from "Andrii Ruzhytskyi" and a comment from "Erik Smith" (highlighted with a red box).
- Right Sidebar:** Contains a "Task Status" section with a dropdown menu (highlighted with a red box) and a "Task Priority" section with a dropdown menu (highlighted with a red box). It also includes a "Worklog" section with a table showing time tracking (15m logged, 15m remaining) and an "Estimate" section with a dropdown menu (highlighted with a red box).

Among the standard Task Name, Description, Attachments, Linked Issues (not present in the screenshot) and Task Activity parts, there are several important and expected to be changed by engineers during the task solution/implementation like:

- 1) **Task Status.** Reflects the current state of the task. An engineer must change task status when necessarily.
- 2) **Time Tracking.** An engineer must log the time spent on the task in JIRA in addition to any worklog software. Must be rounded to 15 minutes (i.e., an engineer has spent 1 hour and 34 minutes – should log 1h 30 min; or it was spent 39 minutes – must log 45 min).

- 3) **Estimate (Original Estimate)**. The time expected by engineer for the task implementation. It's okay if the estimate isn't even. However, it should tend to the hours accuracy – if a task was estimated in 2 hours and engineers spent 3-4h, it's fine, but if it took 6-8h for engineer – that's where the engineer can improve.
- 4) **Sprint**. Reflects if the issue is in the Backlog or in the Sprint. Engineers are expected to work on the tasks from Sprint; however, it's also a case for engineers to work on the tasks from the Backlog to estimate those, or if the task is urgent and should be a #1 priority.
- 5) **Assignee**. The tasks once assigned to engineers usually keeps assigned to the engineers even if task has statuses like Ready For Testing or Waiting For Solutions.
- 6) **Task Priority** helps to identify which task should be next. Changed by Solutions or Engineering Manager. It's also usual for engineers to interact with Engineering Manager to identify their next priorities (Verenia engineers have daily Scrum meetings to discuss the tasks and priorities).

Tasks Workflow:

There are next types of the tasks:

- **Story** (used not much, mostly for the big chunks of the requests, like UI Overhaul).
- **Bug** (used not much, mostly for those issues where we sure it's our internal system issue).
- **Epic** (used for the customer's name, so each epic has the list of the tasks for a particular customer).
- **Task** (the most used type including for issues experienced by customers).
- **Sub-task** (used to decompose big tasks as it's a rule that any task can't be longer than 2 workdays (8+8 hours)).

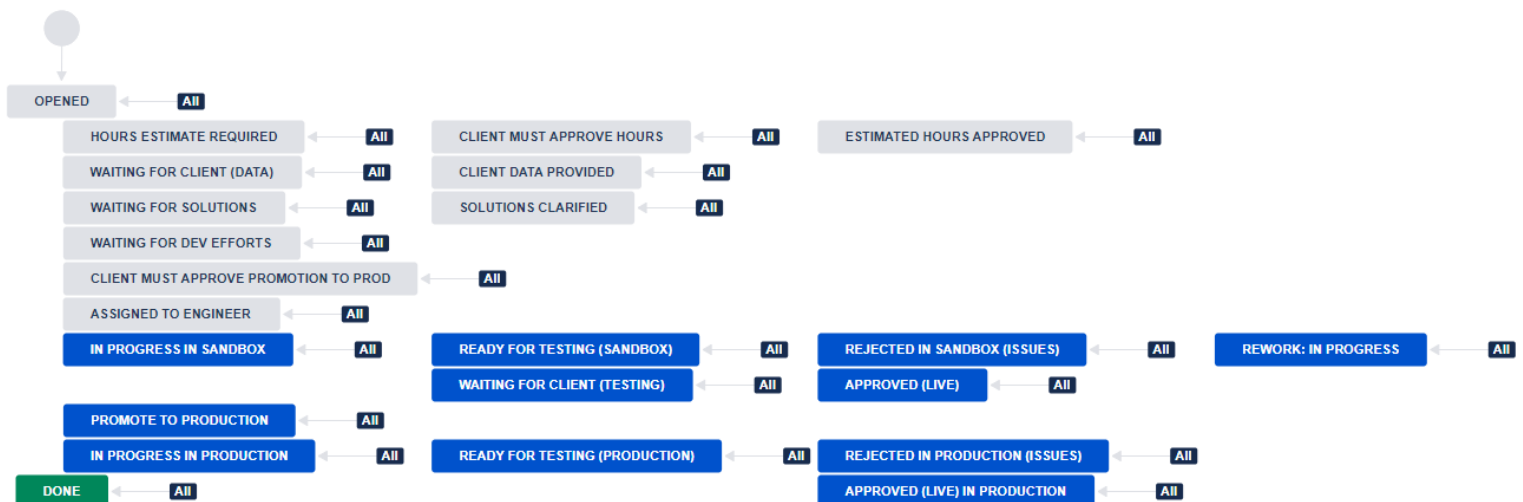
Workflow

Solutions-Engineering Workflow 2022 (View as text / diagram)

Issue Types

-  Story
-  Bug
-  Epic
-  Task
-  Sub-task

The workflow is straightforward, and any Task Status can be chosen in any time to reflect the task condition with the most accuracy.



Our customers utilize SB (Sandbox) environment to make the products, and usually switch (copy everything) to PROD (Production) environment when ready to go live with the product. Some customers have only SB.

- **Opened.** When a new task created, it has this status and must be assigned to Engineering Manager for the further task delegation.
- **Hours Estimate Required.** On Engineer. Engineer can't spend any time sans research and estimation, because customer needs to know the efforts in hours to approve the work on the task.
- **Client Must Approve Hours.** On Customer. Is waiting for the hours being approved to begin the work on the task.
- **Estimated Hours Approved.** On Engineer. Customer approved the estimated hours, and the work can be done.
- **Waiting For Client (Data).** On Customer. It can happen, once started implementation, the task requires clarifications which require additional data from the customer.
- **Client Data Provided.** On Engineer. The task was waiting for the customer data, and it was provided, so the work can continue.
- **Waiting For Solutions.** On Solutions (Technical Lead). It can happen, the task description is clear, but some additional questions raised during the implementation, so Engineer asks the questions in the task comments and waits for the response to continue the work.
- **Solutions Clarified.** The task was waiting for additional clarifications from Solutions, and Solutions provided the answers.
- **Waiting For Dev Efforts.** The existing functionality isn't enough to proceed with the tasks, so Engineer needs to place a comment in the task and change the task status and wait until Developers made the new functionality.
- **Client Must Approve Promotion To PROD.** On Customer. The task in SB (Sandbox) is done, but customer yet isn't ready to get it in PROD (Production).
- **Assigned To Engineer.** On Engineer. The common status after Opened, means the task was delegated to a particular engineer.
- **In Progress In Sandbox.** On Engineer. The Engineer is working on the task, or plans to take the task next in the work.
- **Ready For Testing (Sandbox).** On Solutions. The task was done by Engineer and is waiting for a Technical Lead to check it.
- **Waiting For Client (Testing).** On Customer. The task was done by Engineer, checked by Technical Lead and is waiting for a Customer to check it.
- **Rejected In Sandbox (Issues).** On Engineer. The task was checked either by Solutions, or by Customer, and issues were found.
- **Approved (Live).** On Engineering Manager. The task was checked and approved. The only way from this status is to resolve it to Done, or put it to one of the Client Must Approve Promotion To PROD and Promote To Production.
- **Rework: In Progress.** On Engineer. Once a task was rejected, Engineer continue his work with this status to fix issues. Goes to both, SB and PROD.
- **Promote To Production.** On Engineer. The task was approved in SB and is ready to be done in Production.
- **In Progress In Production.** On Engineer. Engineer works on the task in PROD.
- **Ready For Testing (Production).** On Solutions (Technical Leads). Engineer finished with the task in PROD.
- **Rejected In Production (Issues).** On Engineer. The task was checked either by Solutions, or by Customer, and issues were found.
- **Approved (Live) In Production.** On Engineering Manager. The task was checked and approved. The only way from this status is to resolve it to Done.
- **Done.** The task was resolved.

Feel free to ask Andrii Ruzhyskyi (Engineering Manager) your questions:

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